

What does a bad question look like?

Vague questions

Bad: “what would you give our product out of 10?”

Better: Literally any question which you have thought about for a moment or two.

Leading questions

Bad: “Which aspects of our phenomenal product did you love most”

Better: “Can you talk about three aspects of the product which were positive”

Loaded questions

Bad: “How did our technology help your customer service staff appear less incompetent?”

Better: “How did our technology improve customer service interactions?”

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Double barrelled questions:

Bad: “Did the new login page make processing faster and more secure?”

Better: “Did the new login page make processing faster?”

.... “Did the new login page make processing more secure?”

Absolute

Bad: “Do staff [*always/ever*] make use of the calculation tools currently provided?”

Better: “Do staff make use of the calculation tools currently provided?”

Irrelevant

Bad: “Do you prefer SHA-2 encryption to the previous MD5 implementation?”

Better: Literally anything relevant to the immediate interests and goals of the user. Avoid technical terms where not required. Focus on their goals and tasks.

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Truisims:

Bad: “Is electronic messaging with our system faster than postal delivery?”

Better: “Is electronic messaging with our system adequately fast?”

Indeterminable

Bad: “Are the sales pages navigated in the most efficient order?”
“is the data storage mechanism secure”

The user isn’t the right person to ask. Ask about the impact on usage.

Jargon / technical

Bad: “Are multi-table joins fast in the JPA CRUD repository?”

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